

Mock Test

Part I Listening 35%

Section One Long Conversation 15% (1.5' × 10 = 15')

Directions: In this section, you will hear **TWO** long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear some questions. The conversations and the questions will be spoken **ONLY ONCE**. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices and **mark the corresponding letter on the ANSWER SHEET** with a single line through the centre.

Conversation 1

1. A) One month
C) Three months
- B) Two months
D) Four months
2. A) £550
B) £650
C) £950
D) £1,050
3. A) Commuters
C) Engineers
- B) Students
D) Clerks
4. A) It has a larger size.
B) It has newer appliances.
C) It is divided into sections.
D) It is part of the living space.
5. A) Bank statement
C) Reference letter
- B) Acceptance letter
D) Passport

Conversation 2

6. A) To encourage people to preserve the countryside
B) To help people enjoy being in the countryside
C) To educate people how to learn things effectively
D) To help people get intense physical exercises

7. A) It challenged their assumptions.
B) It made them fitter and better.
C) It taught them new skills.
D) It built their self-esteem.
8. A) You can choose which activities you do.
B) There's such a wide variety of activities.
C) You can become an expert in new activities.
D) You can drop an activity if you don't like it.
9. A) Extra table tennis equipment
B) A selection of films on DVD
C) Their own board games
D) Rock climbing gear
10. A) Hair dryer
B) Cell phone
C) Hairspray
D) Necklaces

Section Two News Report 10% (1' × 10 = 10')

Directions: *In this section, you will hear **THREE** news reports. At the end of each report, you will hear some questions. The news reports and the questions will be spoken **ONLY ONCE**. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices and **mark the corresponding letter on the ANSWER SHEET** with a single line through the centre.*

News report 1

11. A) 9 B) 49 C) 100 D) 110
12. A) Faulty electrical wiring
B) Leaking gas pipes
C) Chemical container
D) Poor ventilation
13. A) Inadequate security guards
B) No sprinkler system installed
C) No fire alarms or detectors
D) Not enough extinguishers

News report 2

14. A) Contaminating condiments and dishes
B) Protesting unsanitary food handling practices
C) Disrupting restaurant operations through vandalism
D) Harassing other diners through unfriendly conversations
15. A) They have been fined by health authorities.
B) They have been brought before the court.
C) They have been taken into custody by the police.
D) They have been banned from entering sushi restaurants.
16. A) The video clip went viral before it's too late to stop.
B) There is intense competition in the sushi industry.
C) The company did poorly in managing a PR crisis.
D) Public fears were exaggerated by media reports.

News report 3

17. A) The material was too thick for running.
B) Athletes found the design outdated.
C) Many uniforms were too similar in style.
D) The outfit showed too much skin.
18. A) By issuing an official apology for any offense caused
B) By stating athletes have options to choose from
C) By clarifying the outfit was not meant for competition
D) By stating the outfit presented was not finalized
19. A) It should focus on comfort instead of looks.
B) It lacked professionalism for elite athletes.
C) It might be a better option for male athletes.
D) Female athletes had no say in its design.
20. A) Nike failed to consider athletes' comfort needs.
B) Female athletes should fight against the outfit.
C) Such outfits should have no place in competition.
D) The controversy attacks women's freedom to choose.

Section Three Passage (10%) (2' ×5=10')

Directions: *In this section, you will hear **ONE** passage. At the end of this passage, you will hear some questions. The passage and the questions will be spoken **ONLY ONCE**. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices and **mark the corresponding letter on the ANSWER SHEET** with a single line through the centre.*

- 21. A) Its annual revenues
B) Its borrowed items
C) Its overall reputation
D) Its public popularity
- 22. A) The way they read books
B) The money they spend on books
C) The way they access books
D) The way they organize books
- 23. A) They like history dramas over modern romance.
B) They tend to buy books based on shows they like.
C) They prefer TV shows over physical books.
D) They tend to buy popular streaming TV shows.
- 24. A) It requires a small amount of annual subscription fee.
B) It offers the complete collections from public libraries.
C) It needs some wait time to process online borrowing.
D) It requires a library card to access the collections.
- 25. A) They require huge maintenance costs for servers.
B) They may cost more to renew their leases.
C) They may have multimedia contents that cost more.
D) They cost a lot more to loan and view online.

Part II Reading Comprehension 45%

Section One Banked Cloze 15% (1.5' × 10 = 15')

Directions: In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank. Read the passage carefully before making your choices. You **must not** use any of the words in the bank **more than once**. Write **the corresponding letter** before the word you choose on **the ANSWER SHEET**.

A. uncomfortable	B. transfer	C. association	D. change	E. reach
F. substitution	G. resist	H. naturally	I. right	J. follow
K. independently	L. create	M. consistent	N. difference	O. anxious

We like to think that we reach conclusions by reviewing facts, weighing evidence and analyzing arguments. But this is not how humans usually operate, particularly when decisions are important or need to be made quickly. What we usually do is arrive at a conclusion (26) _____ of conscious reasoning and then, and only if required, search for reasons as to why we might be (27) _____.

The first process, drawing a conclusion from evidence or facts, is called inferring; the second process, searching for reasons as to why we might believe something to be true, is called rationalizing.

That we rationalize more than we infer seems counter-intuitive, or at least (28) _____, to a species that prides itself on its ability to reason, but it is supported by the work of many researchers. We tend to prefer conclusions that are (29) _____ with our existing world-view, and that don't require us to (30) _____ a pleasant and familiar narrative. We are also more inclined to accept these conclusions, and to (31) _____ those that require us to seriously examine existing beliefs.

There are many ways in which our brains help us to do this. Is global warming too difficult to understand? Your brain makes a (32) _____ for you: what do you think of environmentalists? It can then (33) _____ that impression, positive or negative, to the issue of global warming and presents a conclusion to you in sync with your existing views.

Your brain also helps to make sense of situations in which it has minimal data to work with by creating a close (34) _____ between pieces of information. If we

hear the words “refugee” and “welfare” together, we cannot help but weave a narrative that makes some sort of coherent story. The more we hear this, the more familiar and ingrained the narrative.

Now, if you are a politician or a political advisor, knowing this sort of thing can give you a powerful tool. It is easier to help people rationalize than it is to ask them to infer. More plainly, it is easier to lay down a path for people to (35) _____ than it is to allow them to find their own. Happily for politicians, this is what our brains like doing.

Section Two Multiple Choice Questions 20% (2' ×10=20')

Directions: *There are **TWO** short passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and **mark the corresponding letter on the ANSWER SHEET** with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

1. A recent study published in the journal *Psychology and Aging* found that 59% of US adults aged 50 to 80 believe they look younger than other people their age. Only 6% of adults in the bracket thought (or realized) they looked older than others their age. In short, most of us are delusional. This likely applies to those over 30 as well. Our brains deny mortality through subjective age—how old we feel versus biological age. I'm 40 but feel 29.

2. I'm not totally crazy. I regularly have moments where I am reminded of my passing years. Eating in a restaurant tends to be one of them. Have restaurants become louder recently? Or have I just got more intolerant of noise? Either way, I'm pretty sure I didn't complain about noise levels in my 20s.

3. My skinny jeans are also a constant reminder that I am tragically **over the hill** in the eyes of Gen Z. Then, of course, there are the new random aches and pains – and the fact that I can now get a three-day-long pain in the neck simply from turning my head too fast.

4. Aches, pains and fashion aside, however, nothing makes me feel older than other people my age. I'm not talking about people I see regularly – you don't really notice how they've matured. I'm talking about having an acquaintance from school or university pop up on social media and realizing, with horror, that the fresh-faced teenager you remember is now an ancient-looking adult. “Surely, I

don't look that old?" I mutter to myself on those occasions. Then I study myself in the mirror and realize, oh dear, they have.

5. Not that there's anything wrong with that. I'm not saying getting older – or looking older – is terrible. Far from it: ageing has many perks. I used to be terribly self-conscious and, in my 20s, I would rarely leave the house without makeup. Now I run errands looking like a scarecrow. I wear makeup so rarely that, when I do, my dog becomes instantly alarmed because he knows something weird is up. It's liberating to no longer care what people think.

6. But let's not go overboard here! I'm not welcoming every new wrinkle with open arms. I have various serums and creams in my bathroom. I have plucked out a grey hair or two in alarm. I have internalized many of the ageist messages that society throws at us.

7. You probably have too. We start to absorb ageist messaging from a young age and, thanks to social media, which is full of influencers showing off their skincare routines, that messaging has grown even more potent. One of the country's leading pharmacy chains recently had to put age restrictions on anti-ageing skincare because so many children were buying products that may actually damage their skin.

8. Internalized ageism doesn't just harm your wallet and confidence; it can hugely affect your health. Indeed, a study from 2002 found that people with more positive self-perceptions of ageing lived 7.5 years longer than others. Embrace your subjective age, in other words. There's a lot of truth to the cliché that you're only as old as you feel.

36. How does the author feel when seeing old acquaintances online?

- A) Confused about how much fashion styles have changed
- B) Saddened at how long they have lost contact
- C) Impressed at how healthy and energetic others look
- D) Surprised at signs of maturity and aging in them

37. What does the passage say about the author's behavior in her 20s regarding makeup?

- A) She was concerned about how others perceived her.
- B) Fashion trends led her to experiment with many styles.
- C) Friends constantly complimented her natural good looks.
- D) Makeup was a fun hobby and creative form of self-expression.

38. What impact can internalized ageism have?
- A) Strong determination to fight all societal pressures
 - B) Improvements to physical health and longevity
 - C) Decreased confidence and poor self-esteem
 - D) Early acceptance of all responsibilities of maturity
39. What does the expression “over the hill” (Para. 3) mean here?
- A) Feeling nostalgic about the past
 - B) Being older and past one’s prime
 - C) Experiencing sudden changes in life
 - D) Feeling out of touch with fashion
40. What does the passage suggest about the author’s view on aging?
- A) Critical and dismissive
 - B) Approving and supportive
 - C) Confused and worried
 - D) Concerned and embracing

Passage Two

1. In recent years, many schools have adopted systems that give students more control over the accommodation process. Students can choose a roommate themselves on social media or through matching services. Some schools use campus matching programs like RoomSync or StarRez that can be customized.
2. At the University of Arizona, first-years either pair up or use a matching program. Dana Robbins-Murray from housing and residential life described it as "Match.com for roommates." She says it "gives students control over who they live with and where they live. We find it gives them power to feel more enabled to work through the system because they chose it."
3. David Clark from Emory University says "The outcome we want is students to have a safe, comfortable place to feel where they belong." Roughly 55% of Emory students start paired up from meeting on social media, at events, or knowing each other. Housing isn’t assigned until July to allow matching.
4. Choice, control, comfort, and agency all seem good. But they can also undermine other values and abilities, such as resilience, risk-taking, navigating differences across identity and ideology. College is about encountering the unknown and learning to adapt, even if that means sidestepping a grievously drunk

roommate at 3 a.m.

5. The idea that letting kids pair up on their own to improve mental health doesn't necessarily bear out in the long run. "Roommate experiences are an intense learning experience," Molly Newton, the senior associate dean of students at Bates College, said. "They're fun and they're hard." Bates does not allow students to preselect roommates; instead, administrators handle the matching process themselves.

6. "College is meant to be a time of life when you step out of your comfort zone and you're stretched," says Julie Lythcott-Haims, the author of "Your Turn: How to Be an Adult", "If people are allowed to choose their own roommates, they're inherently cutting themselves off from some of the most significant learning available, which is to grow up your freshman year with someone not like you."

7. The reality is that when kids choose their own roommates, they tend to go with people who are exactly like themselves. Bruce Sacerdote, an economist at Dartmouth College, points to clear advantages to a randomized process, especially since American campuses still see a lot of self-segregation by race, ethnicity and class.

8. Kids who pair up are often the ones who attended private or top-tier public preparatory schools where they can easily fit in with shared acquaintances from their social circles; they're also the kids who have resources to meet up over the summer. Lythcott-Haims argued that allowing students to select their own roommates favors privileged students and encourages cliques to form. This undermines the goal of having a diverse student body where students can learn and develop through interacting with each other.

9. Recognition of this effect has led some schools, like Duke University, to stop letting first-year students self-select. Even though it's hard to remove a privilege that's already been granted, especially when many colleges treat students more like clients or customers whom they aim to please, now is the time for more colleges to take that step.

10. Today's divided campuses need students to learn as much as possible about getting along with the kinds of people they don't know. Kids certainly deserve the chance, too.

41. Why do some schools use campus matching programs?

- A) To randomly assign roommates without student input
 - B) To allow students to customize roommate matching process
 - C) To ensure students choose roommates of similar ideological views
 - D) To prioritize roommate selection based on student financial resources
42. What is one outcome David Clark wants from their housing system?
- A) For students to choose roommates who are different from themselves
 - B) For housing assignments to be made months before the school year starts
 - C) For students to have a safe and comfortable living situation
 - D) For residential life staff to manually assign all roommate pairs
43. What potential advantage may randomized roommate assignments provide?
- A) More opportunity for personal growth through challenging experiences
 - B) Prevention of potential bullying based on different socioeconomic status
 - C) Avoidance of intensity and difficulties common to roommate relationships
 - D) Increased options for students to get to know many potential roommates
44. What argument does Julie Lythcott-Haims make about allowing student roommate selection?
- A) It encourages independence and self-reliance among freshmen.
 - B) It favors privileged students who can self-select comfortable situations.
 - C) It helps achieve the goal of having a diverse campus community.
 - D) It treats college students as customers that institutions aim to please.
45. What does the word “clique” (Para. 8) mean here?
- A) Mix
 - B) Assortment
 - C) Grouping
 - D) Variety

Section Three Matching 10% (1'×10=10')

Directions: In this section, you are going to read **ONE** passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph **more than once**. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by **marking the corresponding letter on the ANSWER SHEET** with a single line through the centre.

- A. When her cellphone's service went down this week because of an AT&T network outage, Bernice stayed calm and called people on her landline, as she grew up with landlines and keeps hers despite having a mobile.
- B. Bernice is in select company by still having a working landline. Landlines are increasingly rare in the digital US, seen as remnants of the past. However, as the outage showed, they can be handy alternatives when cellphones fail. Emergency services suggested using landlines for 911 calls during the outage. Though a good backup, landlines in the US today are definitely the exception, not the rule.
- C. According to the most recent estimates from the National Center for Health Statistics, about 73 percent of American adults in 2022 lived in households where there were only wireless phones and no landlines, while another 25 percent were in households with both. Barely over 1 percent had only landlines. Contrast that to estimates from early 2003, where fewer than 3 percent of adults lived in wireless-only households, and at least 95 percent lived in homes with landlines, which have been around since Alexander Graham Bell invented the telephone in 1876.
- D. Twenty years ago, landline phone service was the "bread and butter" for phone companies, said Michael Hodel, a stock analyst at Morningstar Research Services LLC who follows the telecom industry. Now, he said, "it's become an afterthought," replaced by services like broadband internet access and its multiple ways of making voice contact with others.
- E. What drove the change? It was that shift from telephones being mainly for voice communication to becoming tiny, data-saturated computers that were carried around in our pockets, Mr. Hodel says. Of particular significance: the introduction of Apple's first iPhone in 2007. The rise of the smartphone fundamentally changed people's relationships with the devices in their pockets. "I do think that was the big watershed moment was when smartphone adoption really started to take off," Mr. Hodel said.
- F. The introduction of new technologies impacts existing ones, said Brian Ott, a professor of communication and media. "The new trains us to alter use of the old, even if it remains," he said. "The logic of mobile phones now exists across society, influencing even landline users."
- G. However, the rapid adoption of new technologies can also cause issues, he said, as "we don't understand consequences until after adoption." The outage exemplified this, raising questions about broader disruptions since landlines are less common. While the outage was short-lived, it highlighted potential

problems if cell networks faced wider issues in a world where landlines are no longer as ubiquitous.

- H. Mr. Hodel was skeptical, though, at the notion that people would be unsettled enough to bring landlines and additional phone bills back into their lives. “Unless you really are faced with something dire, the odds of you actually being concerned enough to go out and do something about it, that’s going to cost you some amount of money seems to be pretty low,” he said. “The service that we get where we’re connected the vast majority of the time, if not all the time, has been sufficient to keep people satisfied by and large.”
46. Landline phone service used to be the primary source of revenue for telephone companies but now they focus more on other services like broadband internet.
 47. The network outage highlighted potential communication problems if cell networks faced broader disruptions since fewer homes now have landlines.
 48. The introduction and widespread adoption of smartphones fundamentally changed how people use and interact with their mobile devices.
 49. Recent studies found that a large number of adult households were wireless-only, with fewer households having only landlines.
 50. Emergency services recommended using landlines instead of cellphones during a specific network outage due to landlines being a more reliable backup option.
 51. The unveiling of a particular type of phone was a critical moment in the rise of smartphone.
 52. The rapid adoption of new technologies can sometimes cause unforeseen issues as the full consequences are not understood until after widespread use.
 53. There is some doubt that people would return to paying for landline phone service as long as wireless connectivity is consistently reliable.
 54. New technologies shape how older ones are used even if the older technologies remain available.
 55. Statistics show that a vast majority of people had landlines in their homes in early 2000s.